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Preparing for eVAL: EDS Staff Setup

A preparation guide for districts onboarding to eVAL

eVAL is Washington's teacher and principal evaluation system. Before your district begins using eVAL, your staff need to be set up in **EDS** (OSPI's Education Data System). This guide explains what that setup involves and who does it, so your district can prepare ahead of time.

You can complete this EDS setup now — it does not require access to eVAL.

Why EDS Comes First

eVAL doesn't manage its own accounts. It gets every staff member — along with their building(s) and eVAL role(s) — from **EDS**. Before anyone can use eVAL, their EDS account must exist and be associated with the right building and role.

This is set up by your **District Security Manager (DSM)**, before eVAL setup begins.

Good to know — This happens in EDS, before eVAL

Once eVAL is live, new or changed staff flow into it automatically (a nightly sync, and on the person's first sign-in). If someone is missing from eVAL or has the wrong school or role, the fix is almost always in EDS.

Your District Security Manager (DSM)

Every district has at least one **DSM** who manages EDS access. You likely already know yours; if not, OSPI publishes a current list:

- **District Security Manager list:** <https://eds.ospi.k12.wa.us/securitymanagerlist.aspx>

The DSM is usually already comfortable with EDS — so preparing for eVAL is mainly about telling them what eVAL needs.

What the DSM Does for eVAL

For each person who will use eVAL, the DSM:

1. **Confirms they have an EDS account.** Most teachers and principals already do — OSPI requires an EDS account to register a teaching certificate. Staff in non-certificated roles (a District Admin, for example) may need a new account created.
2. **Associates their building(s) and eVAL role(s)** — for example, *Principal at Lincoln Elementary*, or *District Admin for the district*.

The role assigned in EDS becomes the person's role in eVAL. (See the companion handout, *eVAL Roles*, for what each role does.)

Tip — Head Principal covers Principal + School Admin

At a school with more than one principal, assign the lead the **Head Principal** role — it automatically includes the **Principal** and **School Admin** roles, so don't add those separately. At a school with a single principal, just assign **Principal**.

Caution — Match the role to the building type

EDS won't stop you from putting a **district** role on a **school** building, or a **school** role on the **district** — but those mismatches don't work correctly in eVAL. Keep school roles (Teacher, Principal, Head Principal, School Admin) on **schools**, and district roles (District Admin, District Evaluators) on the **district**.

Start Small — Add Roles Only If Needed

Give each person the fewest roles that cover what they actually do, and add more later only if needed. Two common over-assignments to avoid:

- **District Admin already covers it.** A District Admin can do everything a **District Assignment Manager** (manage assignments) or a **District Viewer** (read-only oversight) can. Don't stack those on top of District Admin — assign the narrower role only to people who *aren't* District Admins.
- **District Teacher Evaluator is for the district, not a school.** Only assign **District Teacher Evaluator** to someone who genuinely works at the district level and evaluates teachers across multiple schools. A principal already evaluates the teachers at their own school through the **Principal** role — they don't need (and shouldn't be given) District Teacher Evaluator.

Learn More (OSPI)

EDS is an OSPI system, so OSPI maintains the authoritative how-to guides:

- **EDS Administration Manual (2025)** — managing accounts and role associations, including descriptions of every available role: https://ospi.k12.wa.us/sites/default/files/2025-06/eds-administration-manual_2025.pdf
- **EDS Bulk Upload Instructions** — for larger districts loading many staff at once: <https://ospi.k12.wa.us/sites/default/files/2023-08/edsbulkuploadinstructions.pdf>

Quick Checklist

- ☐ Identify your District Security Manager (DSM)
- ☐ Confirm an EDS account exists for every staff member who will use eVAL
- ☐ Create EDS accounts for any non-certificated staff who need one (e.g., District Admins)
- ☐ Associate each person's building(s) and eVAL role(s) in EDS
- ☐ Use **Head Principal** at multi-principal schools (covers Principal + School Admin)
- ☐ Keep school roles on schools and district roles on the district

- ☐ Start with the minimum roles each person needs